

actions. Once you know the tricks that retailers use to get us to spend, it's easier to resist them, and once you identify the feelings that trigger unhealthy spending habits, it's easier to seek out other self-soothing techniques that don't rely on spending and won't end up costing you your wellbeing in the long run.

When your relationship with money is broken, it can feel impossible to look ahead, or to imagine that there is a future in which you are in control of your money and using it to make proactive, positive manoeuvres and decisions. In repairing it, you open up a world of possibilities, and creating a plan for your financial future will give you the sense of freedom and security that underpins a full sense of financial wellbeing. Looking at where your money is going and the future that it's helping to build, both in the wider world and in your own life, will help you to feel more connected to your finances, while knowing that you have a safety net and are working towards your goals will fulfil some of those vital needs in Maslow's hierarchy.

These five steps represent, in my opinion, the key building blocks of a healthy and happy relationship with money. They will give you a pathway for reaching your financial potential without sacrificing too many of your other resources or tricking you into thinking that your worth is dependent on your financial success. These steps take into account the whole being, rather than just the bank account, and many of the skills that you'll develop as you move through the stages